

Session 0: Getting Started with R and RStudio

Installation, Interface, and Data Import

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R and RStudio installation

Installation

This term, our sessions run in R, which requires that you have R and RStudio installed in your computer:

Instructions

- To install R, visit (<https://cran.r-project.org>) and select a Comprehensive R Archive Network (CRAN) mirror close to you.
- To install RStudio, go to <https://www.rstudio.com/>. Note that you need to install R first.
- To use RStudio, you need to download R to your computer. RStudio helps you use the version of R that lives on your computer, but it doesn't come with a version of R on its own.

Getting started

Getting started - RStudio interface

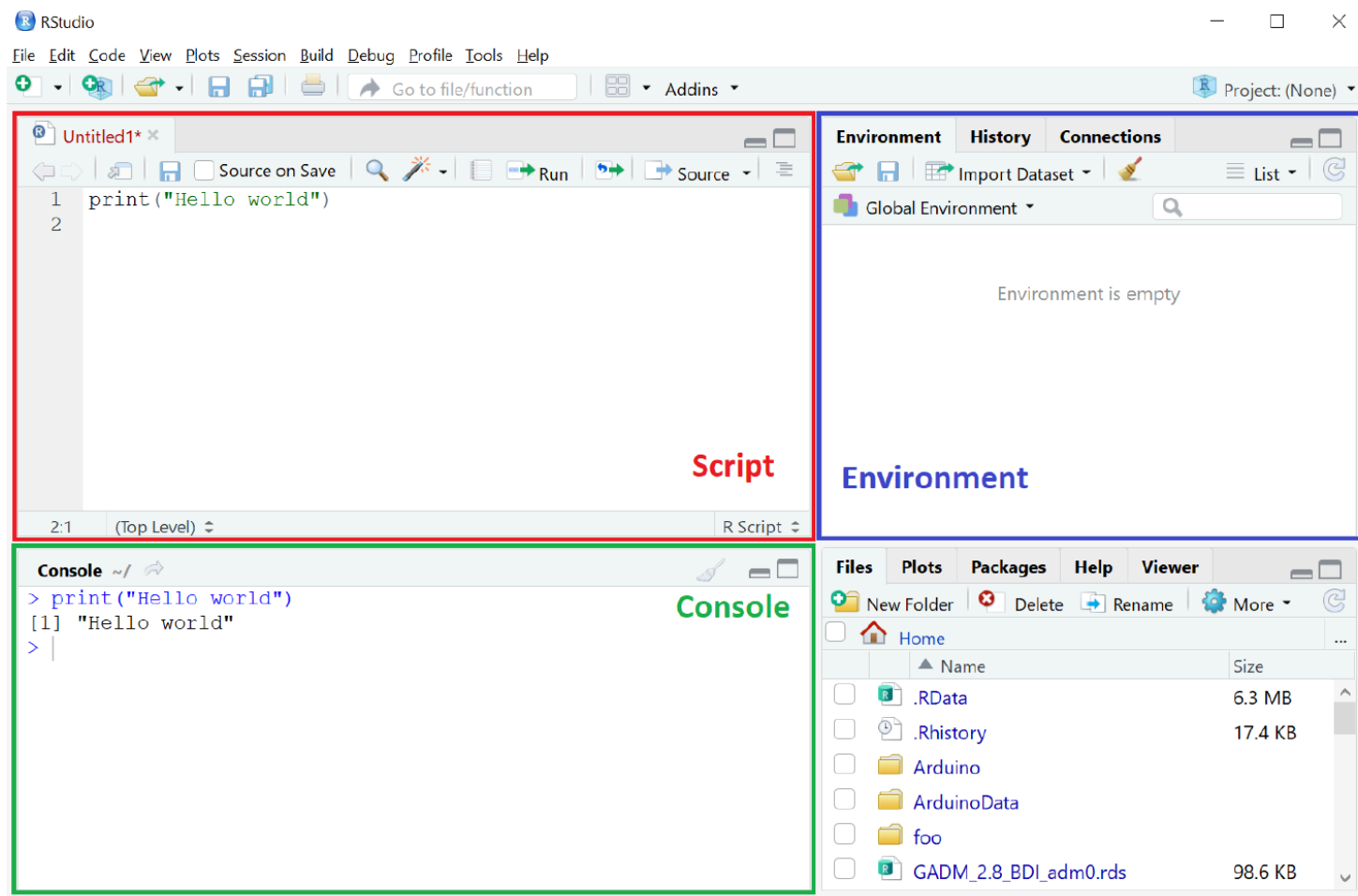
Script: Where you write your code. Just like a do file.

Console: Where your results and messages will be displayed. But you can also type commands directly into the console, as in Stata.

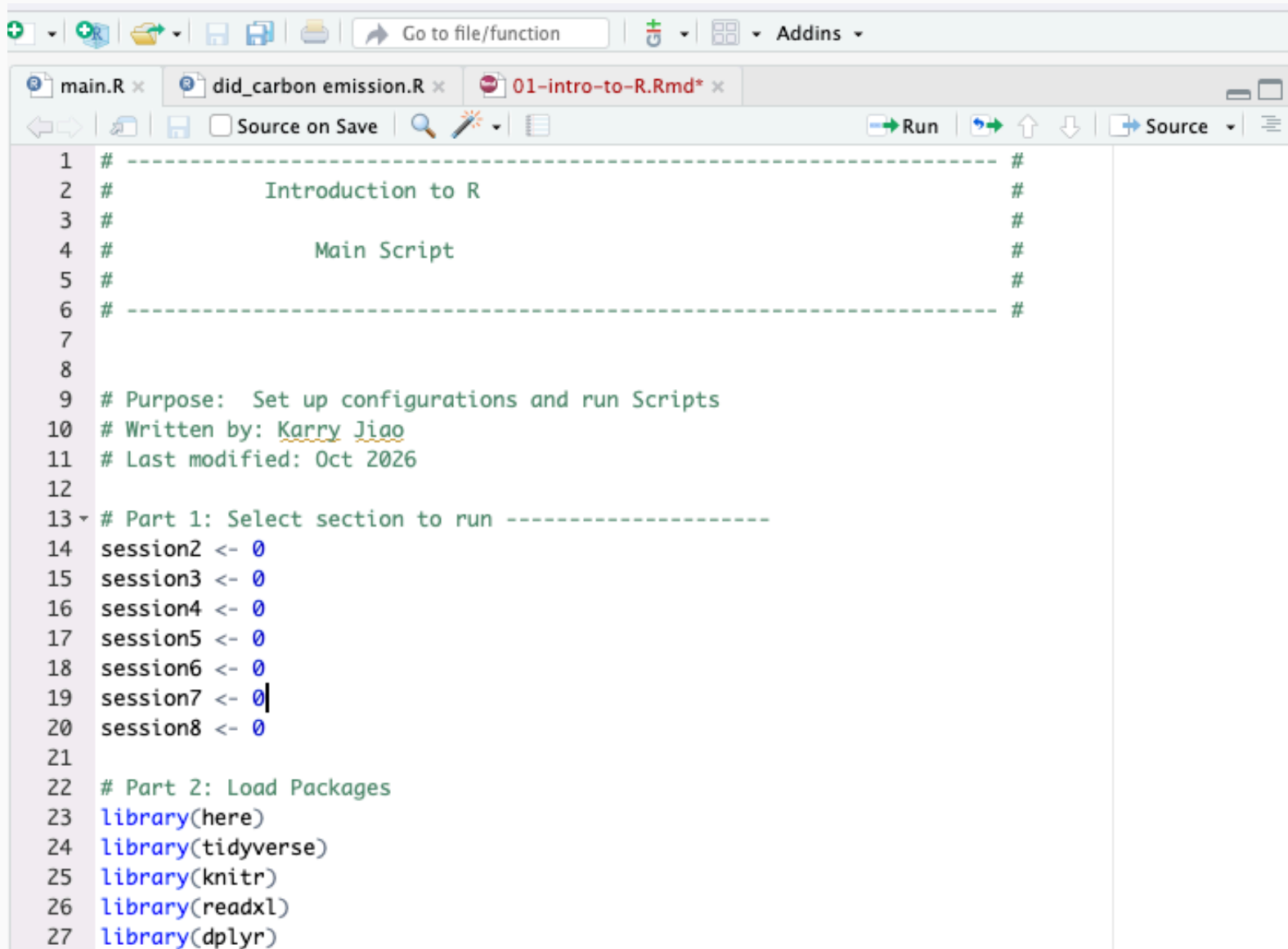
Environment: What's in R's memory.

The 4th pane: Can display different things, including plots you create, packages loaded and help files.

Getting started - RStudio interface



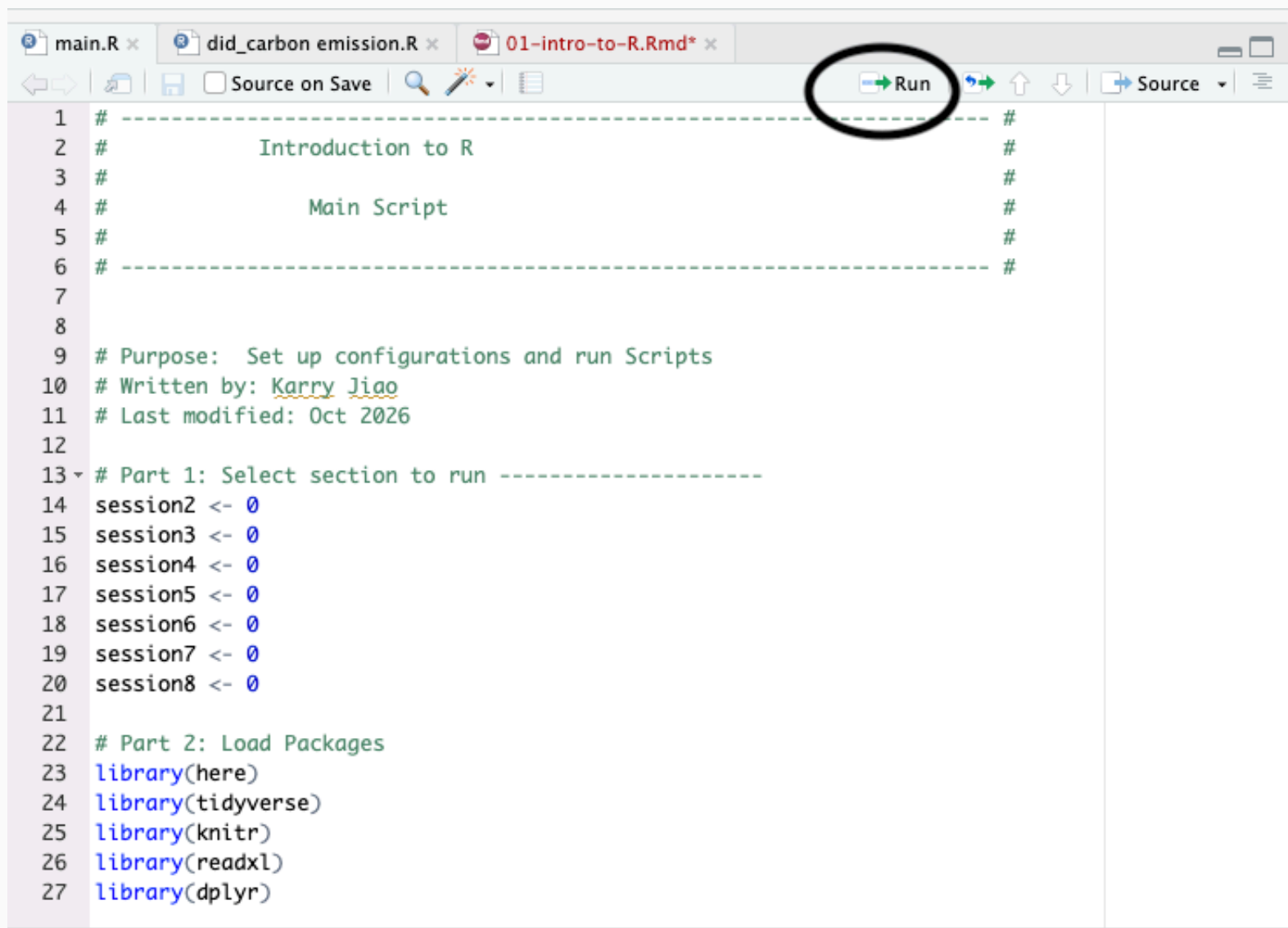
Getting started - RStudio interface



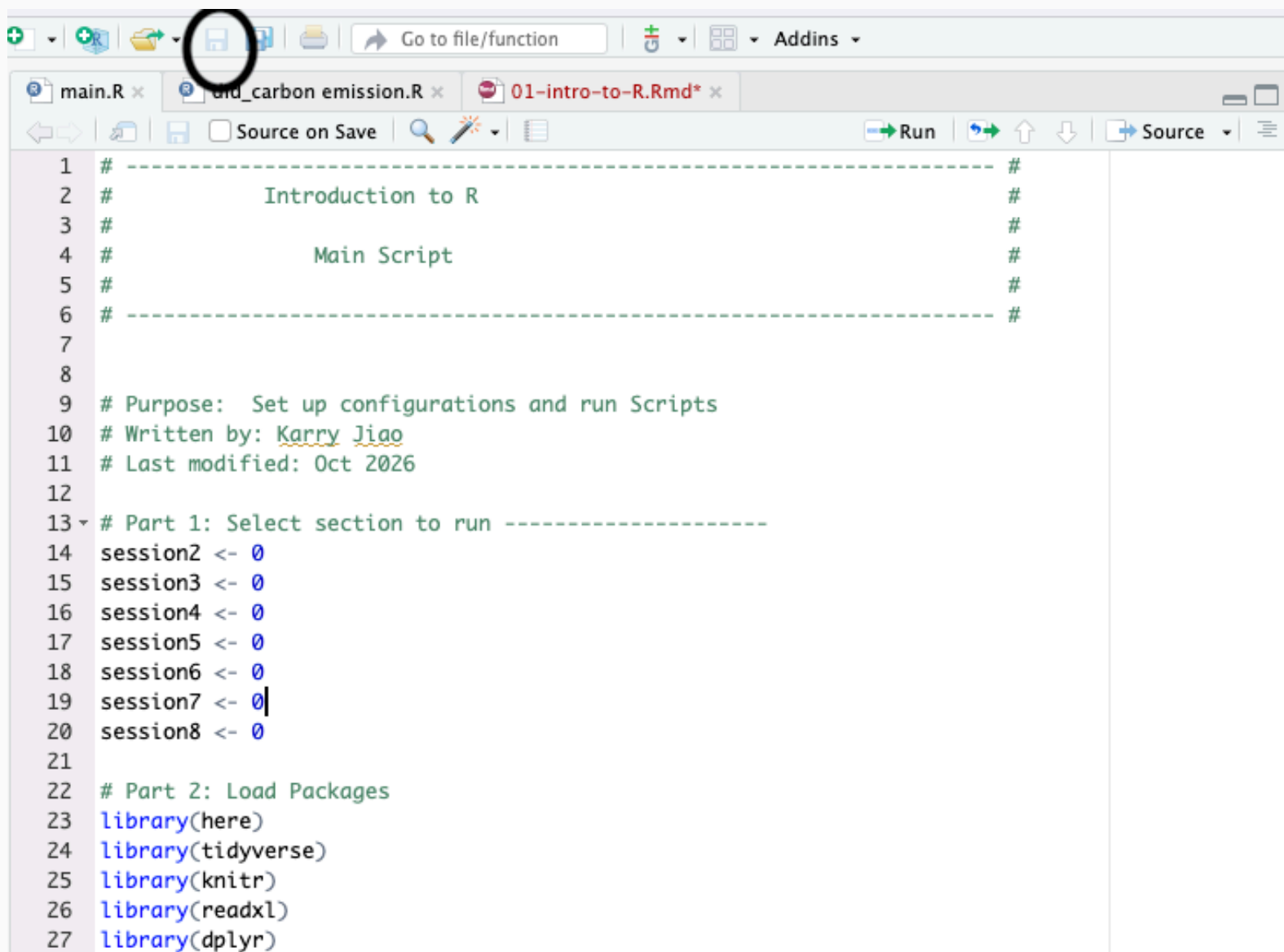
The screenshot displays the RStudio interface. At the top, there is a toolbar with icons for file operations (new, open, save, print) and a search bar labeled 'Go to file/function'. Below this is a tab bar showing three open files: 'main.R', 'did_carbon emission.R', and '01-intro-to-R.Rmd*'. The '01-intro-to-R.Rmd*' tab is active, and its content is visible in the editor. The editor shows a script with line numbers 1 through 27. The script includes comments for an introduction and main script sections, followed by a list of session variables (session2 through session8) all set to 0. The script also includes a section for loading packages, with 'library(here)' and 'library(tidyverse)' highlighted in blue. The right side of the interface is currently empty.

```
1 # ----- #
2 #           Introduction to R           #
3 #                                     #
4 #           Main Script                #
5 #                                     #
6 # ----- #
7
8
9 # Purpose: Set up configurations and run Scripts
10 # Written by: Karry Jiao
11 # Last modified: Oct 2026
12
13 # Part 1: Select section to run -----
14 session2 <- 0
15 session3 <- 0
16 session4 <- 0
17 session5 <- 0
18 session6 <- 0
19 session7 <- 0
20 session8 <- 0
21
22 # Part 2: Load Packages
23 library(here)
24 library(tidyverse)
25 library(knitr)
26 library(readxl)
27 library(dplyr)
```

Getting started - RStudio interface



Getting started - RStudio interface



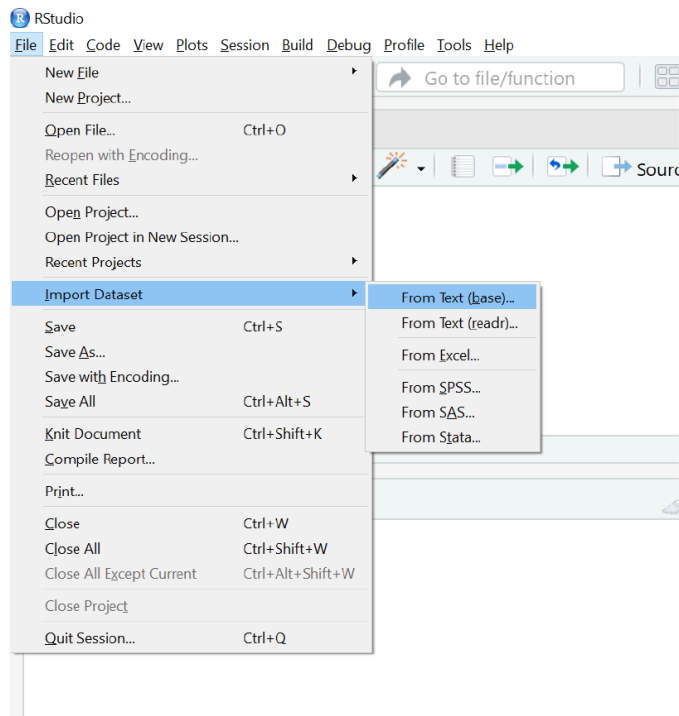
Getting started - Importing data

Let's start by loading the data we'll be using:

Exercise 1: Import data manually (🕒 3 min)

1. Go to the link <https://osf.io/v2hsn> and download the file `whr_panel.csv` (click on the vertical ellipsis next to the file name)
2. In RStudio, go to `File` > `Import Dataset` > `From Text (base)` and open the `whr_panel.csv` file.
3. Assign the name `whr` to the data on the Import Dataset window.
4. If you solved the exercise correctly, you'll see that RStudio opens a tab with a viewer of the dataframe

Getting started - Importing data



Getting started - Importing data

Import Dataset

Name

whl

Encoding

Automatic

Heading

☒ Yes
 ☐ No

Row names

Automatic

Separator

Comma

Decimal

Period

Quote

Double (")

Comment

None

na.strings

NA

☐ Strings as factors

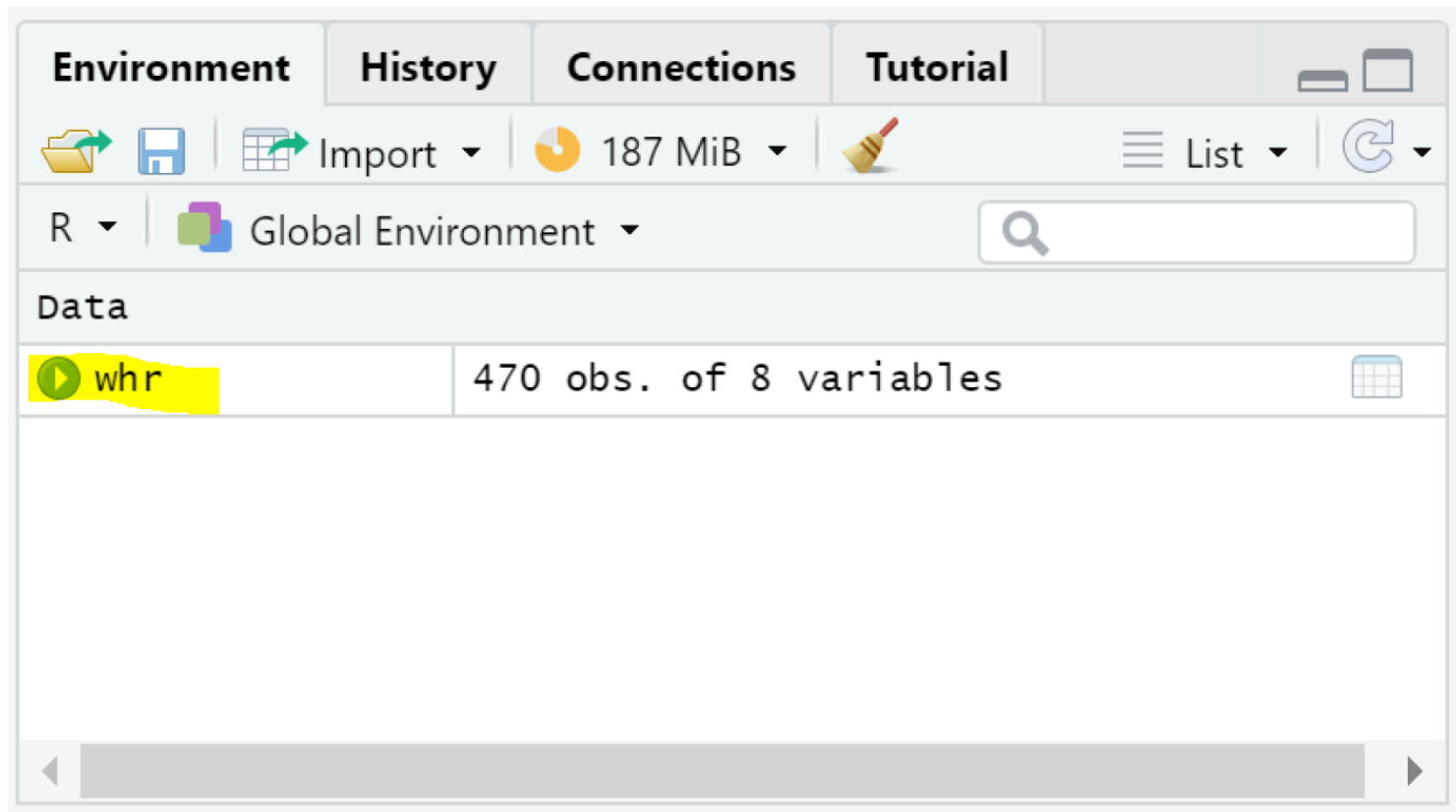
Input File

Denmark,Western Europe,2015,3,7.527,1.32548,0.87464,0.64931
 Norway,Western Europe,2015,4,7.522,1.459,0.88521,0.66973
 Canada,North America,2015,5,7.427,1.32629,0.90563,0.63297
 Finland,Western Europe,2015,6,7.406,1.29025,0.88911,0.64169
 Netherlands,Western Europe,2015,7,7.378,1.32944,0.89284,0.65988
 Sweden,Western Europe,2015,8,7.364,1.33171,0.91087,0.65988
 New Zealand,Australia and New Zealand,2015,9,7.286,1.25018
 Australia,Australia and New Zealand,2015,10,7.284,1.33358,0.65988
 Israel,Middle East and Northern Africa,2015,11,7.278,1.22819
 Costa Rica,Latin America and Caribbean,2015,12,7.226,0.95505
 Austria,Western Europe,2015,13,7.2,1.33723,0.89042,0.62433
 Mexico,Latin America and Caribbean,2015,14,7.187,1.02054,0.61779
 United States,North America,2015,15,7.119,1.39451,0.86179,0.61779
 Brazil,Latin America and Caribbean,2015,16,6.983,0.98124,0.61779
 Luxembourg,Western Europe,2015,17,6.946,1.56391,0.91894,0.61779
 Ireland,Western Europe,2015,18,6.94,1.33596,0.89533,0.61779
 Belgium,Western Europe,2015,19,6.937,1.30782,0.89667,0.58419

Data Frame

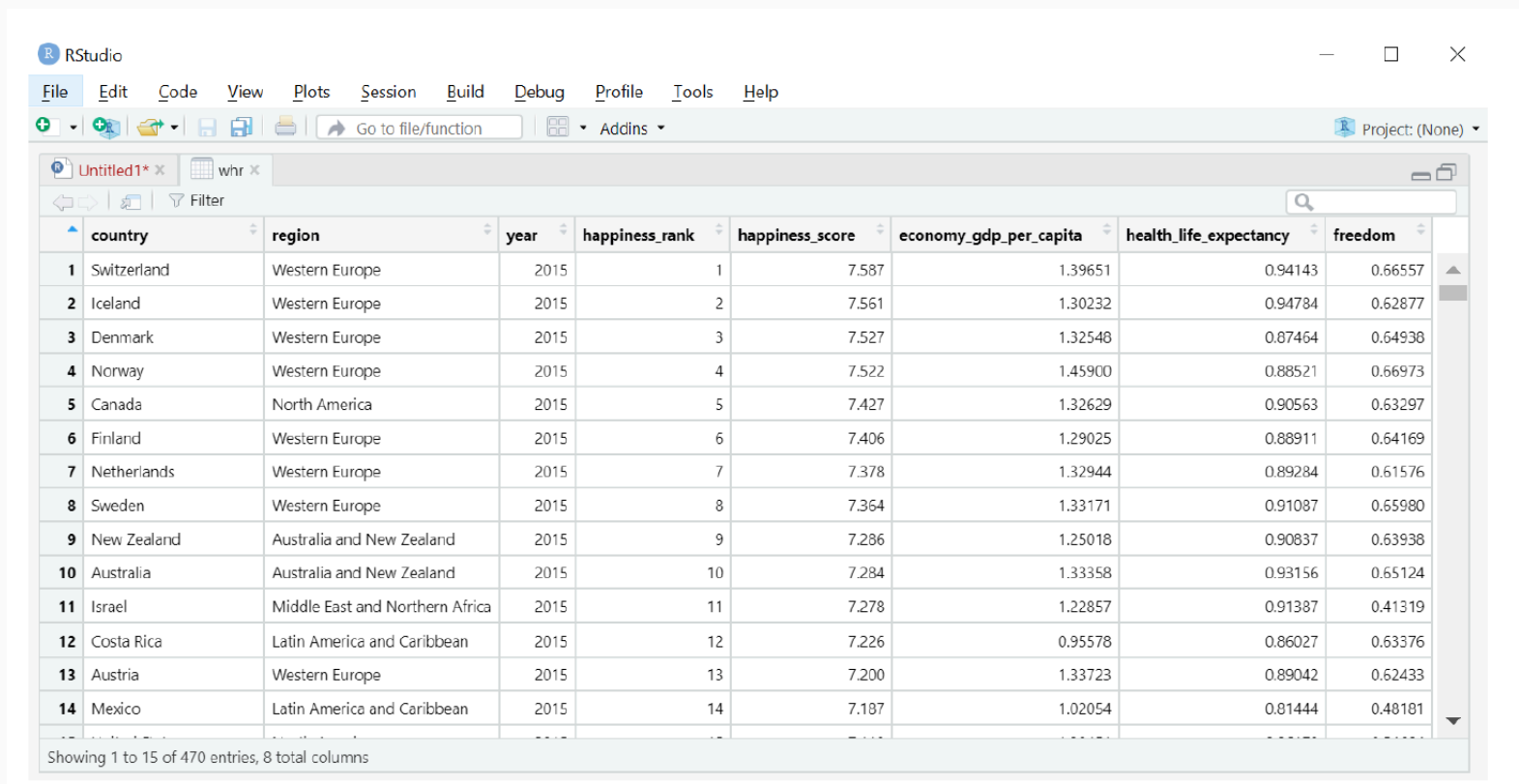
country	region	year
Switzerland	Western Europe	2015
Iceland	Western Europe	2015
Denmark	Western Europe	2015
Norway	Western Europe	2015
Canada	North America	2015
Finland	Western Europe	2015
Netherlands	Western Europe	2015
Sweden	Western Europe	2015
New Zealand	Australia and New Zealand	2015
Australia	Australia and New Zealand	2015
Israel	Middle East and Northern Africa	2015
Costa Rica	Latin America and Caribbean	2015

Getting started - Importing data



Getting started - Importing data

You'll also note that RStudio by default opens a visualizer of the data we just loaded.



RStudio

File Edit Code View Plots Session Build Debug Profile Tools Help

Go to file/function Addins Project: (None)

Untitled1* x whr x

Filter

	country	region	year	happiness_rank	happiness_score	economy_gdp_per_capita	health_life_expectancy	freedom
1	Switzerland	Western Europe	2015	1	7.587	1.39651	0.94143	0.66557
2	Iceland	Western Europe	2015	2	7.561	1.30232	0.94784	0.62877
3	Denmark	Western Europe	2015	3	7.527	1.32548	0.87464	0.64938
4	Norway	Western Europe	2015	4	7.522	1.45900	0.88521	0.66973
5	Canada	North America	2015	5	7.427	1.32629	0.90563	0.63297
6	Finland	Western Europe	2015	6	7.406	1.29025	0.88911	0.64169
7	Netherlands	Western Europe	2015	7	7.378	1.32944	0.89284	0.61576
8	Sweden	Western Europe	2015	8	7.364	1.33171	0.91087	0.65980
9	New Zealand	Australia and New Zealand	2015	9	7.286	1.25018	0.90837	0.63938
10	Australia	Australia and New Zealand	2015	10	7.284	1.33358	0.93156	0.65124
11	Israel	Middle East and Northern Africa	2015	11	7.278	1.22857	0.91387	0.41319
12	Costa Rica	Latin America and Caribbean	2015	12	7.226	0.95578	0.86027	0.63376
13	Austria	Western Europe	2015	13	7.200	1.33723	0.89042	0.62433
14	Mexico	Latin America and Caribbean	2015	14	7.187	1.02054	0.81444	0.48181

Showing 1 to 15 of 470 entries, 8 total columns

Getting started - Importing data

Lastly, you'll see that these two commands were automatically introduced and executed in the Console panel.

```
> whr_panel <- read.csv("~/Desktop/R training/Bennett R Training/bennettschool_statistics_TA/code/  
DataWork/DataSets/Final/whr_panel.csv")  
> View(whr_panel)  
> |
```

This is because when we clicked `File` > `Import Dataset` > `From Text (base)` and imported the data, we implicitly told RStudio to execute these two commands.

Any questions? Feel free to send me an email.

- (Email address on the first page)